

KURUKSHETRA: A LIFE · 29 OCTOBER 2026

Art brief: divine weapons and magic

A supplement to the storylines brief, for PRD §18.7 to §18.9: divine weapons and shields earned through blessings, penance and hard tests; magic and blessings paid for with tapas (spiritual merit); and a fully animated puppet. This brief lists the pictures they need. The weapons' effects in a fight, the puppets and their new moves are drawn by the game, so they need no paintings.

Group	What	Images	Shape
A	Emblems for the weapons, shields, magic and tapas	**14**	1:1 PNG
B	Test stages for earning them (tall and wide)	**12**	9:16 and 16:9
C	Scenes: the temptation, the mountain, the sacrifice, the sage's service, the mother's thread	**5**	16:9
Total		**31**	

All are for features not built yet. The emblems (A) come first: the game needs them before any weapon or charm can appear.

RULES

Rules for this brief

Everything in the main art brief applies: the game's warm, painterly early-historic India; no text; timber, brick and stone; no blood; made or licensed for this project, AI use noted. Three rules matter most here:

- **No divine figures.** Gods, sages' visions and blessings are shown as light, fire, water, a voice's effect on the world, or a symbol. Never a figure of Shiva, Indra, Varuna, Agni or any other god.
- **Weapons as objects, not violence.** An astra is an arrow, a mantra, a glow; show its nature (fire, water, wind, sleep, serpent), never its harm.
- **The great weapons stay unseen.** The Brahmastra appears only as a temptation: a fire at night and what it might cost, never the weapon in use.

Shapes

Kind	Size	Notes
Emblem	512×512 PNG, transparent background	Matches the path and vow emblems already in the game (shown on the next page): a single bold motif, warm gold and ochre on dark, readable at 48px.
Test stage, tall	1080×1920 (9:16)	Phones. One of the five layouts (A scene, B top-down, C side view, D course, E fight) described in the storylines brief.
Test stage, wide	2560×1440 (16:9), or 2560×720 for side and course views	Laptops, desktops, tablets. Same place and light as the tall one.
Scene	2560×1440 (16:9)	The game cuts its 3:1 banner from the middle band: subject in the centre 40% of the width and the middle third of the height; calm lower half.

GROUP A · 14 IMAGES

Emblems

Small square emblems shown on the character sheet, in fight moves, in choices and in the journal. Match these existing emblems:



path_archer path_healer vow_vengeance vow_never_lie

File	For	Motif
emblem_agneyastra.png	**Agneyastra (fire weapon)**	An arrow whose head is a single upright flame
emblem_varunastra.png	**Varunastra (water weapon)**	An arrow wrapped in a curling wave, a drop at its tip
emblem_vayavyastra.png	**Vayavyastra (wind weapon)**	An arrow trailing three swirling wind lines
emblem_sammohana.png	**Sammohana (stupor)**	A half-closed eye over a crescent of sleep lines (not a moon crescent: three soft arcs)
emblem_nagapasha.png	**Nagapasha (serpent noose)**	A serpent coiled into a loop, its head resting on its tail
emblem_brahmastra.png	**The Brahmastra (refused temptation)**	A blade of white fire inside a closed ring, as if held back
emblem_kavacha.png	**A sage's kavacha (armour)**	A gold breastplate of overlapping scales with a small sun boss (not Karna's: plainer)
emblem_charmed_shield.png	**Charmed shield**	A round hide shield with a lotus boss and a faint glow at the rim
emblem_raksha_sutra.png	**Raksha sutra**	A red and gold thread tied in a knot around a wrist
emblem_bala_atibala.png	**Bala and Atibala mantras**	Two flames side by side over a strong open hand
emblem_sanjivani.png	**Mritasanjivani root**	A pale glowing root with three leaves, drops of light falling from it
emblem_antardhana.png	**Antardhana (vanishing)**	A figure's outline fading into dots from one side
emblem_soma.png	**Soma**	A small clay cup with a stalk of soma plant and a rising swirl
emblem_tapas.png	**Tapas (spiritual merit)**	A small steady flame on a clay lamp, ringed by a thin circle of light

GROUP B · 12 IMAGES

Test stages for earning them

Six new places, each as a tall and a wide painting, where the player earns a weapon or a charm. Each names an existing stage to match.



stage_fire_altar_tall · stage_fire_altar

Test stage · layout A (scene) · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Penance for the Agneyastra: holding still at a fire altar through a season of storms (a steady test).

Paint: A brick fire altar (vedi) in a forest clearing at night, its fire burning low and steady; storm clouds, wind bending the trees, rain beginning. Open ground in front of the altar. No figures; the light of the fire is the presence.

Match: stage_forest_clearing_night_tall



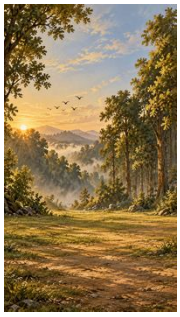
stage_deep_lake_tall · stage_deep_lake

Test stage · layout D (course, downward) · 1080×1920; wide 2560×720

Used for: Diving for a sage's lost offering for the Varunastra (a breath test, swimming down).

Paint: Under the water of a deep forest lake: light from the surface fading to green and then dark blue, lotus stems and roots, stones, a glint of a brass offering bowl far below. The tall version must tile top to bottom.

Match: stage_forest_lake_tall



stage_himalaya_climb_tall · stage_himalaya_climb

Test stage · layout D (course) · 1080×1920; wide 2560×720

Used for: The climb to a Himalayan hermitage for the Vayavyastra; also the climb for the Mritasanjivani root.

Paint: A narrow mountain path climbing up the picture: rock, snow at the edges, prayer-flag-free (no Tibetan flags), wind-blown snow, a tiny hermitage with a thin smoke line high above. Tiles top to bottom.

Match: stage_forest_edge_tall



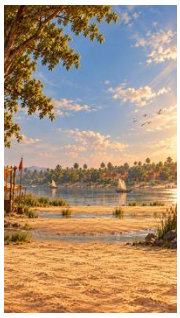
stage_gandharva_river_tall · stage_gandharva_river

Test stage · layout A (scene) · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Answering a Gandharva's riddles for Sammohana; sparing a defeated Gandharva.

Paint: A riverbank at moonrise: a silk canopy and cushions left on the sand, a vina lying on a cushion, lamps floating on the water, mist. The Gandharva is not shown (he is drawn by the game as a puppet). Open sand in front.

Match: stage_lotus_garden_tall



stage_naga_riverbank_tall · stage_naga_riverbank

Test stage · layout A (scene) · 1080×1920 and 2560×1440

Used for: Healing a wounded naga for the Nagapasha (a healing test).

Paint: A shaded riverbank at dusk: tangled roots of a great tree over the water, a hollow among them, stones carved with old serpent shapes, fireflies. Open ground in front. No serpent shown (the game draws it).

Match: stage_river_shallows_tall



stage_temple_night_tall · stage_temple_night

Test stage · layout C (side view) · 1080×1920 and 2560×720

Used for: Returning a stolen offering to a temple by night (stealth).

Paint: An early-historic shrine court at night, side-on: a low brick and timber shrine (no tall spire), a pillared veranda, lamps in niches, a priest's lamp moving far off. Calm at both ends.

Match: stage_palace_corridor_tall

GROUP C · 5 IMAGES

Scenes

Five moments that frame the weapons and magic. Faces out of frame or seen from behind; no divine figures.



scene_brahmastra_offer

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: The one time the Brahmastra is offered, and the price explained; the player may refuse.

Paint: A lone fire at night on a bare hilltop above the sleeping armies; the fire burns white at its heart, and the grass around it is bent outward as if by a great breath. Far below, two camps of tiny fires. Ominous, quiet. No figure, no weapon shown.

Match: scene_raid



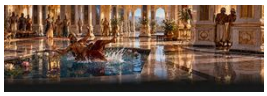
scene_shiva_mountain

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: A test at Shiva's mountain: the god is never shown, only light and a voice.

Paint: A snow peak at dawn above clouds, a shaft of light falling on a single flat stone where a small offering of flowers lies, a trident-shaped break in the clouds at most (subtle, not a drawn trident). No figure.

Match: end_forest



scene_yajna_soma

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: A great sacrifice (yajna) at Indraprastha or Hastinapura, where soma is offered.

Paint: A great sacrificial ground: a brick fire altar in the centre, priests in white seen from behind or small, clay vessels and pressing stones for soma, ghee being poured, smoke rising into a bright sky, a crowd far off.

Match: scene_rajasuya



scene_sage_service

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: A year of serving a sage: carrying water, sweeping, keeping silent.

Paint: A hermitage in the forest across the seasons: a simple hut, a sacred fire, a broom and water pots by the door, a path to a stream; one half of the picture in monsoon green, the other in winter mist, joined softly. The sage only small and seen from behind.

Match: scene_ashram



scene_raksha_sutra

Scene · 2560×1440

Used for: Before the war: a mother or spouse ties the protective thread on the player's wrist.

Paint: Lamplight in a house the night before the army marches: two pairs of hands only, close up, one tying a red and gold thread on the other's wrist; a lamp, a plate of rice and kumkum, a sword wrapped in cloth beside them. Faces out of frame.

Match: scene_years_remain

ALSO

What needs no paintings

- **The puppets and their new moves** (jump, duck, sidestep, block; joints and rods; ageing, gear and scars): drawn by the game in the tholu bommalata style.
- **The weapons in a fight** (a fire, water, wind or serpent cut-out flying across the stage, the counter-weapon meeting it in mid-air): drawn by the game as leather cut-outs.
- **Tapas, blessings and charms on the character sheet**: the emblems in group A.

Delivery and checklist

- Name every file exactly as listed (emblems as .png with transparency; stages as _tall.jpg and .jpg; scenes as .jpg).
- One zip per group; partial batches are fine, group A first. Upload to art_review/ in the GitHub repo, or attach in the chat.
- Render at native size wherever your tool allows; if it cannot, send the native render alongside the enlarged file. Note which pieces are AI-generated and which tool made them.

- ☐ Emblems 512×512 PNG with transparent background, one bold motif, readable at 48px, matching the path and vow emblems
- ☐ Stages: tall 1080×1920; wide 2560×1440 (side and course views 2560×720); course stages tile top to bottom
- ☐ Scenes 2560×1440 with the subject in the centre band
- ☐ No divine figures anywhere; no weapon shown harming anyone; no Brahmastra in use
- ☐ No people up close in stages; no faces in the raksha sutra scene; no text, signatures or watermarks
- ☐ Period details right: no tall temple spires, Tibetan prayer flags, domes or later forms
- ☐ Made or licensed for this project; AI use noted